

First Week After Pentecost

In Festo Ssmae Trinitatis

1962 TLM: Trinity Sunday; ferias may use the Mass of the First Sunday after Pentecost

Source note. In the 1962 Missale Romanum the Sunday after Pentecost is the feast of the Most Holy Trinity. The ferial Mass of the First Sunday after Pentecost begins *Domine, in tua misericordia speravi* and gathers the same post-Pentecost movement into mercy, charity, and judgment.

Proper	TLM text / reference	Scriptural axis	Fathers and saints	Connection
Introit	<i>Benedicta sit sancta Trinitas</i> (Tob. 12:6; Ps. 8)	Praise and mercy	St. Augustine, <i>De Trinitate</i> ; St. Gregory Nazianzen, theological orations	The Church begins ordinary growth after Pentecost by adoring the source of all mission: one God, three Persons.
Collect	Confession of true faith: know Trinity, adore unity	Faith seeking worship	St. Athanasius on Nicene confession; St. Thomas Aquinas, <i>Summa Theologiae</i> I, qq. 27-43	Doctrine is not abstract here; right confession becomes protection from adversity.
Epistle	Rom. 11:33-36	Incomprehensible wisdom	St. John Chrysostom on Romans; Augustine on divine simplicity	The apostle ends in doxology where reason reaches its limit: <i>ex ipso, per ipsum, in ipso</i> .
Gospel	Matt. 28:18-20	Baptismal name and mission	St. Hilary of Poitiers on Matthew; St. Leo the Great on Pentecost and mission	The Trinitarian name is the form of Christian rebirth and the grammar of evangelization.
Offertory	<i>Benedictus sit Deus Pater... Filius... Spiritus</i>	Mercy revealed	St. Bonaventure, <i>Itinerarium</i> ; St. Elizabeth of the Trinity	The offering is praise returned to the God whose mercy first descended.
Communion	<i>Benedicimus Deum caeli</i>	Public confession	St. Basil, On the Holy Spirit	Communion sends the worshipper from hidden mystery to public thanksgiving.
Postcommunion	<i>Proficiat nobis ad salutem corporis et animae</i>	Sacrament and confession	St. Thomas Aquinas on sacramental fruit; Augustine on confession of faith	The received sacrament profits body and soul as confession of the eternal Trinity becomes saving participation.
Ferial First Sunday	1 John 4:8-21; Luke 6:36-42	Charity and mercy	Augustine on 1 John; St. Benedict, Rule ch. 4	The ferial Mass unfolds Trinity into moral likeness: mercy because the Father is merciful.

Four Senses of Scripture

Thread	Synthesis
Literal	Matthew 28 gives Christ's explicit command to baptize all nations in the one Name of the Father, Son, and Holy Ghost; Romans 11 confesses the unfathomable wisdom of God.
Allegorical	The baptismal Name reveals the mystery hidden in all salvation history: the Father sends the Son, and the Holy Ghost gathers the nations into the Church.
Moral	The ferial Gospel's command to be merciful shows the ethical fruit of Trinitarian life. The baptized must become merciful because he has been named by divine charity.
Anagogical	The doxology of Romans points beyond mission and moral effort to the final contemplation of God: <i>ex ipso, et per ipsum, et in ipso sunt omnia</i> .

Core Scriptural Symbols

Thread	Synthesis
Name	The Gospel commands baptism in the one Name of Father, Son, and Holy Ghost, while the Introit and Communion bless and confess God before all the living. Scripturally, the Name is God's self-disclosure, not a human label: Moses receives the divine Name, Israel blesses it, and the Church is plunged into it. The Fathers therefore read the baptismal formula as the revelation of consubstantial communion. The faithful are being taught that Christian identity begins by being named into God, so doctrine, worship, and mission are all received before they are performed.
Depth	Romans' <i>O altitudo</i> gives the Mass its intellectual posture. The abyss is not emptiness but inexhaustible wisdom: judgments unsearchable, ways untraceable, providence deeper than argument. Patristic exegesis treats this depth as the school of humility, where reason is purified into doxology. The symbol prevents a flat Trinity Sunday; the mystery is not solved but adored, and the homilist should let wonder do real doctrinal work.
Mercy	Tobit's repeated confession that God has dealt mercifully with us frames the feast with gratitude. Mercy is the mode in which the hidden Trinity becomes visible to creatures: creation, redemption, baptism, Eucharist, and mission are all condescensions of divine goodness. The ferial first Sunday texts make the symbol moral: the baptized must become merciful because he has been received into the life of charity.
Doxology	The Mass begins with blessing, passes through Paul's doxology, and returns through Offertory and Communion to public confession. Doxology is the soul's truthful speech before mystery. The Fathers often treat praise as the proper end of theology: when speech can no longer comprehend, it can still bless. This makes worship the organizing symbol of the week; the Church teaches by making the faithful praise before they analyze.
Mission	Matthew's nations are not a merely geographic horizon. Mission flows from the Name: the Father sends the Son, the Son commands the apostles, and the Spirit gathers the nations into baptismal communion. The symbol joins contemplation to action. The Church is missionary because she has first beheld and confessed the source from whom all things come, through whom all things are redeemed, and in whom all things return.

Patristic Exegesis of the Grouped Propers

The Church does not set Trinity Sunday before the faithful as a speculative interruption after Pentecost. The Fathers read the appointed texts as a single movement: revelation exceeds the mind, yet enters history through the baptismal Name and returns from the altar as praise, mercy, and mission. The Mass teaches that the incomprehensible God is not remote; he is the source, form, and end of the Christian life.

Thread	Synthesis
Introit: Tobit and Psalm 8	Patristic reading blesses the God who shows mercy and makes his majesty known through creation. The liturgical function is doxological: before the faithful analyze the mystery, they are made to bless Father, Son, and Holy Ghost.
Collect: true faith and unity	The Fathers' anti-Arian and pro-Nicene reading insists that confession and worship cannot be divided. The Church asks not merely to understand propositions, but to be guarded by the worship of the one divine glory.
Epistle: Romans 11	Chrysostom and Augustine read Paul's <i>O altitudo</i> as the mind bowing before providence. The text diagnoses intellectual pride: right theology ends in adoration when it reaches the depth it cannot master.
Gospel: Matthew 28	Hilary and the Nicene Fathers read the baptismal formula as a public confession of the one divine Name, not three unequal powers. The Church shows that mission begins from revealed communion: the nations are gathered by being baptized into the Trinitarian Name.
Offertory, Communion, Postcommunion	The repeated blessing of God in Father, Son, and Spirit turns doctrine into sacrifice, thanksgiving, and sacramental fruit. Basil's defense of the Spirit's glory clarifies the movement: the same God confessed in the Gospel is adored at the altar and received unto salvation.
Ferial first Sunday texts	Augustine's reading of 1 John and Luke's mercy command shows the moral fruit of Trinity: charity and mercy are not added topics but the visible likeness of the God into whose Name Christians are baptized.

Thread	Synthesis
Revelation and humility	Romans teaches that divine wisdom is unsearchable; Matthew teaches that the same mystery is named in baptism. The Church therefore forms humble confessors, not silent skeptics or confident system-builders.
Doctrine and worship	The Introit, Collect, and Offertory make dogma liturgical. The faithful learn the Trinity by blessing, adoring, receiving, and confessing before they learn to explain.
Mission and mercy	The Gospel sends the Church to all nations; the ferial Gospel commands mercy. Patristic exegesis holds these together: evangelization without mercy falsifies the divine Name it claims to preach.
Baptism and Eucharist	Baptism gives the Name; Eucharist trains the baptized in thanksgiving; the Postcommunion asks that this reception profit body and soul. The grouped propers teach that sacramental life is Trinitarian from entrance to consummation.
Church's instruction	The faithful are being told: adore what exceeds you, confess what has been revealed, receive the Name sacramentally, and let Trinitarian charity become merciful judgment, speech, and mission.

Exegetical Notes

- Romans 11 ends not with explanation but doxology. Paul's *O altitudo* teaches the preacher to let mystery remain mystery.

- Matthew 28 reveals that baptism is entry into the one divine Name, not into a private religious project.
- The ferial Gospel, Luke 6:36-42, guards Trinitarian orthodoxy from becoming censorious. The Father is merciful; the child must become merciful.

Witness	Short text	Homiletic use
St. Augustine	“You see the Trinity if you see charity.” <i>De Trinitate</i> , VIII	Use this as the bridge from doctrine to life: charity is not a replacement for dogma but dogma made visible.
St. Athanasius	The Son is confessed as true God, not a creature elevated by favor.	The Gospel’s baptismal formula only makes sense if the Son and Spirit belong to the divine life.
St. Basil	The Spirit is glorified with the Father and the Son.	Pentecost is completed by worship of the Spirit, not merely by invoking spiritual energy.
St. Elizabeth of the Trinity	Her prayer is to become a “praise of glory.”	A contemplative application: the baptized person becomes a living doxology.

Thread	Synthesis
Trinity and mission	Pentecost gives the Spirit; Trinity Sunday names the divine life from which that gift proceeds. The Mass moves from confession to mission: the Church baptizes because she has first adored.
Mercy and doctrine	The ferial Gospel against judgment is not detached moralism. It is the ethical shape of Trinitarian faith: charity mirrors the God who first loved.
Creed and altar	The Introit blesses the Trinity; the Offertory returns the same blessing through sacrifice. The whole Mass is a Trinitarian act: to the Father, through the Son, in the Holy Ghost.
Prayer focus	Ask for firm faith that becomes merciful action, especially in speech, judgment, and fraternal correction.

Preaching Applications

- Correct false humility: the Trinity is beyond comprehension, but not beyond confession, adoration, and love.
- Invite the hearer to examine whether zeal for truth has become harshness toward the brother for whom Christ died.
- End with baptismal identity: every Christian life is signed by the Name into which it was baptized.

Primary References

- Missale Romanum 1962, Proprium de Tempore, *In Festo Ssmae Trinitatis; Missa Dominicae Primae post Pentecosten*.
- Local source: the 1962 temporal proper file listed in the project README.

Full Patristic and Saintly Texts

- St. Augustine, *De Trinitate*, VIII: “Nay, but you see the Trinity if you see love.”
- St. Augustine, Homily 7 on First John: “If you would not die of thirst in this wilderness, drink charity.”